

Your PF balance is one SMS away.

No internet needed.

How to check your EPF balance by SMS, missed call, app or website, what to look for in your passbook, and the EPF rules every salaried person should know.

You commented "PDF", so here it is. Every month, 12% of your basic salary goes into your Provident Fund, and your employer adds 12% more. Most people never check whether that money actually reached their account. This guide shows you how, in under a minute.

- 1 **Check it today.** Send one SMS or give one missed call from your registered mobile. No app, no password, no internet.
- 2 **Fix what blocks it.** UAN not activated, mobile not linked, or KYC pending. Here is how to sort each one.
- 3 **Read your passbook.** Your share, your employer's share, pension and interest. What to verify every few months.

WAYS TO CHECK	SMS LANGUAGES	INTEREST 2025-26	TIME IT TAKES
4	10	8.25%	1 min

Check by SMS, *in your language*

This works on any phone, even a basic keypad phone. The SMS has to go from the mobile number linked to your UAN.

TYPE THIS MESSAGE

EPFOHO UAN TAM

SEND IT TO

77382 99899

Type the word **UAN** as it is. Do not replace it with your UAN number; EPFO finds your account from your mobile number. The last three letters choose the reply language. Leave them out and the reply comes in English. Normal SMS charges from your operator may apply.

1 Pick your language code

ENG English	HIN Hindi	TAM Tamil	TEL Telugu	KAN Kannada
MAL Malayalam	MAR Marathi	GUJ Gujarati	PUN Punjabi	BEN Bengali

2 Four steps

- 1** **Open messages on your registered mobile.** This is the number you gave while activating your UAN. Not sure which one? Check your salary slip for your UAN and log in to the member portal to see the linked number.
- 2** **Type the message.** EPFOHO, space, UAN, space, language code. Example for Tamil: **EPFOHO UAN TAM**.
- 3** **Send it to 77382 99899.** The reply usually comes within a few minutes.
- 4** **Read the reply.** It shows your latest contribution and your PF balance, along with the KYC details (Aadhaar, PAN, bank) linked to your UAN.

Or just *give a missed call*

Even simpler than SMS. Dial, and your PF details come back by SMS.

GIVE A MISSED CALL TO

99660 44425

WHAT IT COSTS

Nothing

Call from your registered mobile only. The call disconnects automatically after a couple of rings, so there is no charge. The reply SMS shows your last contribution and balance.

3 Before either method works

Both need three things in place. If you get no reply, one of these is usually missing.

YOU NEED	HOW TO GET IT DONE
UAN activated	Your UAN (12 digits) is on your salary slip or with HR. Activate it on the EPFO member portal or the UMANG app using your Aadhaar-linked mobile.
Mobile number registered	Set during UAN activation. If your number changed, update it on the member portal after logging in.
KYC seeded	At least one of bank account, Aadhaar or PAN linked to your UAN. On the member portal: Manage, then KYC. Your employer approves it.

4 No reply? Check these

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
Sent from another number	Send again from the number linked to your UAN.
Typed your UAN number in the SMS	Type the word UAN, not the number: EPFOHO UAN ENG.
New job, first salary just paid	The first contribution can take a few weeks to show. Check again next month.
Company runs its own PF trust	Some large companies manage PF in their own trust. EPFO can't show that balance; ask HR for the trust statement.
Still nothing	Raise a query on epfigms.gov.in or call the EPFO helpline 1800-118-005.

The full passbook, *month by month*

SMS gives you the total. The passbook shows every monthly deposit, so you can see if your employer skipped a month.

5 On the UMANG app

- 1 **Install UMANG** (the government's official app) and register with your mobile number.
- 2 **Search "EPFO"** and open it. Choose **View Passbook** under Employee Centric Services.
- 3 **Enter your UAN** and the OTP sent to your registered mobile.
- 4 **Pick the member ID** for each employer. You'll see the balance and every entry.

6 On the EPFO passbook website

- 1 **Go to passbook.epfindia.gov.in**. Type the address yourself rather than tapping a link someone forwarded.
- 2 **Log in** with your UAN, password, captcha and the OTP.
- 3 **Select your member ID** and tap View Passbook. Download the PDF if you want to keep a copy.

7 Which method when

METHOD	INTERNET	BEST FOR
SMS	Not needed	Quick balance in your own language
Missed call	Not needed	Fastest check, zero cost
UMANG app	Needed	Full passbook on your phone
Passbook website	Needed	Downloading the passbook PDF, all employers in one place

The passbook can take a few hours to show after UAN activation. Members of exempted company trusts won't see their balance on EPFO.

Where your 24% *actually* goes

You put in 12% of basic pay plus DA. Your employer also puts in 12%, but most of that goes to your pension, not your PF.

CONTRIBUTION	RATE	AT ₹25,000 WAGE	GOES TO
Your share	12%	₹3,000	Your EPF account
Employer share to EPF	3.67%	₹917	Your EPF account
Employer share to EPS	8.33%	₹2,083	Pension fund (not withdrawable like PF)
Total per month	24%	₹6,000	₹3,917 to EPF, ₹2,083 to pension

New from 17 September 2026: the PF wage ceiling went up from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000 a month, so the maximum pension contribution rises from ₹1,250 to ₹2,083. If you earn above the ceiling, the split depends on whether your company contributes on full basic pay.

8 Three columns in every passbook

Employee share

YOUR MONEY

12% from your salary each month, plus the interest it earns.

"Idhu un salary-la irundhu."

Employer share

COMPANY'S MONEY

The 3.67% part of your employer's 12%, plus its interest.

"Company kudukkura bonus maadhiri."

Pension (EPS)

FOR MONTHLY PENSION

The 8.33% part. Earns no interest here; it funds a pension after 10 years of service.

"Retirement-ku appuram maasam varum."

WHAT TO CHECK EVERY FEW MONTHS

1. A deposit for **every month** you were paid. A gap means your employer missed it.
2. The amount is **12% of your basic** on your salary slip.
3. **Interest** is credited once a year for the last financial year.
4. **Name and date of birth** match your Aadhaar exactly.
5. Old employers' member IDs are **transferred** into your current one, so nothing is left behind.

The numbers *behind* your PF

EPF pays more than most fixed-income options and is tax-free if you leave it alone. These are the rules that matter.

RULE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
Interest rate	8.25% a year for 2025-26, the same as the two years before. Worked out monthly, credited once a year after the government notifies the rate.
Tax on your contribution	Your share qualifies for Section 80C (old tax regime only), within the ₹1.5 lakh limit.
Tax on interest	Tax-free on your own contributions up to ₹2.5 lakh a year. Interest on anything above that is taxable.
Tax on withdrawal	Tax-free after 5 years of continuous service. Before 5 years it's taxable, with 10% TDS if you withdraw more than ₹50,000 and your PAN is linked.
Partial withdrawal	Allowed after 12 months of service, under three heads: essential needs, housing and special circumstances. 25% of your balance must stay in the account.
Pension (EPS)	Monthly pension from age 58 if you have at least 10 years of service.
Life cover (EDLI)	Free insurance for every EPF member. If a member dies while in service, the family gets between ₹2.5 lakh and ₹7 lakh.

Withdrawal rules were simplified in late 2025 and parts of EPFO 3.0 (like UPI withdrawal) are still rolling out. Check the current rule on the EPFO site before you file a claim.

THE ONE THING TO NOTICE

Checking your PF is good. Withdrawing it for a phone, a trip or a wedding gift is not. Every rupee you leave alone compounds at 8.25% until you retire.

WATCH OUT FOR FAKE HELPERS

EPFO never asks for your UAN password, OTP or bank details over a call, WhatsApp or SMS. Checking your balance is free. Nobody needs to charge you a fee for it.

How the facts *were checked*

EPFO rules and numbers change. This is where each fact came from, checked on 5 October 2026.

1. EPFO SMS (77382 99899) and missed call (99660 44425) services, language codes and conditions: EPFO member services, summarised by ClearTax "PF Balance Check".
2. EPF interest rate of 8.25% for FY 2025-26, recommended by the Central Board of Trustees in March 2026; 8.25% for FY 2023-24 and FY 2024-25: Press Information Bureau and Upstox.
3. Wage ceiling raised from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000, effective 17 September 2026, S.O. 5109(E) under the Code on Social Security, 2020: BDO India alert and EPFO FAQs.
4. Partial withdrawal rules (three categories, 12 months of service, 25% minimum balance) approved by the CBT in October 2025: The Tribune.
5. Auto-settlement limit of ₹5 lakh and TDS on withdrawal before 5 years: EPFO updates, summarised by KnowMoney.
6. EDLI cover of ₹2.5 lakh minimum to ₹7 lakh maximum: EPFO EDLI scheme page.
7. Tax treatment of EPF interest above ₹2.5 lakh a year: Income Tax Act, Section 10(12).

9 Check it yourself

WHAT	WHERE
Passbook and balance	passbook.epfindia.gov.in · UMANG app
UAN activation, KYC, mobile update	unifiedportal-mem.epfindia.gov.in
Complaints	epfigms.gov.in · 1800-118-005

DISCLAIMER

This guide is for education only. It is not financial, tax or legal advice, and it does not recommend any financial product. I am not affiliated with or paid by EPFO or any app or service named here.

EPF rules, rates, limits and tax treatment are set by the government and EPFO and can change. Verify the current rules on the official EPFO website, and speak to a qualified professional before you withdraw or make decisions about your PF.

Checked your PF balance? *Tell me in the comments.*

Free to share. Made by Abinash at [@buildwithabinash](#). Send this to a friend who has never checked their PF.